

Marketing Campaign Approval SOP

Syed Motors · Document Code: SOP-06 · Type: sop · Department: Marketing

Purpose

How marketing collateral, social posts, and paid campaigns are reviewed and approved before publication.

Effective from the first working day of the current calendar year. Reviewed annually by the document owner and revised as necessary. Version 1.0.

1. Brief

Every campaign starts with a written brief covering objective, target audience, budget, timeline, and success metric. The brief is approved by the marketing manager before any creative work begins.

The written brief establishes the basic direction of the campaign before creative production starts. It records what the campaign is intended to achieve, who it is intended to reach, the planned budget, the timeline, and how success will be measured.

Approval by the marketing manager is required before creative work begins. This places the brief approval at the start of the campaign process.

2. Brand Review

Creative work must follow the OEM brand book. Vehicle imagery must be OEM-approved. Colour, logo placement, and taglines are verified against the brand book by the marketing manager and, for above-the-line campaigns, by the OEM brand team.

The brand review therefore covers both the general creative treatment and specific vehicle imagery. The marketing manager performs the stated verification, while the OEM brand team is involved for above-the-line campaigns.

3. Legal Review

Price claims, comparison claims, and warranty claims must be reviewed by the finance manager and, if necessary, the external legal retainer, before publication.

4. Publication and Tracking

Approved campaigns are published on scheduled dates. Performance is reviewed weekly, and a post-campaign report is prepared within 15 days of campaign closure.

1. Brief - Campaign Foundation

The campaign brief is the starting document for every marketing campaign. It is prepared before creative work begins and must cover five defined areas.

Objective. The brief states what the campaign is intended to accomplish. This gives the creative and publication work a defined purpose.

Target audience. The brief identifies the audience for whom the campaign is intended.

Budget. The planned campaign budget is recorded in the brief.

Timeline. The campaign timeline establishes the intended schedule for the work.

Success metric. The brief defines the metric that will be used to assess campaign success.

Brief Approval

The marketing manager approves the written brief before any creative work begins. This approval is a prerequisite for moving from campaign planning into creative production.

The brief therefore acts as the initial reference point for the campaign. Creative work follows the approved campaign direction rather than beginning independently of the brief.

Campaign Scope

The SOP applies to marketing collateral, social posts, and paid campaigns. The brief process provides a common starting point across these forms of marketing activity.

Planning Record

Keeping the campaign information together in the written brief allows the marketing team to refer back to the campaign objective, audience, budget, timeline, and success metric during later review and reporting.

2. Brand Review - Creative Compliance

After the brief is approved and creative work is developed, the material is reviewed against the OEM brand book.

OEM brand book. Creative work must follow the OEM brand book. It provides the reference for the stated brand elements.

Vehicle imagery. Vehicle imagery must be OEM-approved before publication.

Colour. Colour is verified against the brand book.

Logo placement. Logo placement is verified against the brand book.

Taglines. Taglines are verified against the brand book.

Review Responsibility

The marketing manager verifies colour, logo placement, and taglines against the brand book. For above-the-line campaigns, the OEM brand team also performs the stated verification.

This creates an additional review role for above-the-line campaigns. The SOP does not remove the marketing manager's stated verification responsibility when OEM brand team review also applies.

Vehicle Imagery

Vehicle imagery has a specific approval condition separate from the general brand review. The imagery used in campaign material must be OEM-approved.

Publication Readiness

The brand review is part of the approval path before publication. Creative material that has not completed the required review should not be treated as an approved campaign asset.

3. Legal Review - Claims

Certain claims require review before publication. The SOP specifically identifies price claims, comparison claims, and warranty claims.

Price claims. Statements relating to price are subject to review by the finance manager before publication.

Comparison claims. Claims comparing products, offers, or other items are subject to the stated review requirement.

Warranty claims. Statements relating to warranty are included in the claims that require review.

Review Participants

The finance manager reviews the identified price, comparison, and warranty claims. Where necessary, the external legal retainer also reviews them before publication.

The external legal retainer is described as an additional reviewer when necessary. The SOP does not state that the external legal retainer is required for every claim.

Publication Gate

The claims review takes place before publication. This means the required review must be completed before the campaign is released on its scheduled publication date.

4. Publication and Tracking

Once the campaign has been approved, it is published on the scheduled date. The tracking stage continues after publication through weekly performance review.

A post-campaign report is prepared within 15 days of campaign closure. The report provides the documented end point of the campaign tracking process.

Marketing Campaign Approval Quick Reference

SOP-06 establishes the Marketing department process for reviewing and approving marketing collateral, social posts, and paid campaigns at Syed Motors.

1. Brief

Start every campaign with a written brief covering objective, target audience, budget, timeline, and success metric. The marketing manager must approve the brief before creative work begins.

2. Brand Review

Creative work must follow the OEM brand book. Vehicle imagery must be OEM-approved. The marketing manager verifies colour, logo placement, and taglines against the brand book. For above-the-line campaigns, the OEM brand team also performs the stated review.

3. Legal Review

Price claims, comparison claims, and warranty claims must be reviewed by the finance manager and, if necessary, the external legal retainer before publication.

4. Publication and Tracking

Approved campaigns are published on scheduled dates. Performance is reviewed weekly, and a post-campaign report is prepared within 15 days of campaign closure.

Approval and Ownership

This document is owned by the Marketing department and approved by the Branch Manager. Questions or clarifications should be directed to the document owner. Non-compliance is a disciplinary matter under the HR Policy Manual.

Document Reference

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